Curriculum Vitae

2026



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Profile Summary

Alejandro Oporto Velásquez is a PhD candidate in Economics at the University of Girona, under the supervision of Dr. Andreas Kyriacou. His research studies the political economy of public finance and policy in Bolivian municipalities, using applied econometrics and policy evaluation methods. He previously worked at Bolivia's Ministry of Economy and Public Finance and State Autonomy Service, and as a Research Assistant at the Institut d'Economia de Barcelona (IEB) and the University of Barcelona. He holds a Master's degree in Economics from the University of Barcelona, including an exchange at the University of Copenhagen.

Working Papers

2026: *"When Do Local Governments Respond to Their Neighbors? Evidence from an Exogenous Revenue Shock"*. Working paper.

Work in Progress

"Holding the Power to Tax: De Jure Autonomy and De Facto Exercise in Bolivian Municipalities".

"Does It Matter Who Heads the List? Electoral Parity, Women's Representation and Local Public Spending: Evidence from Bolivian Municipalities".

Education

2025 – 2028: PhD candidate in Economics, University of Girona.

2022 – 2024: Master in Economics, University of Barcelona.

Aug 2023 – Jan 2024: Exchange student at the University of Copenhagen, within the Master in Economics, University of Barcelona.

2022: Causal Inference Methods for Impact Assessment, Institute for Advanced Development Studies, La Paz, Bolivia.

2021: Territorial Analysis with Georeferenced Information, Institute for Advanced Development Studies, La Paz, Bolivia.

2020: Indicators for Development, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).

2019 – 2020: Master in Economics, Private University of Bolivia, La Paz, Bolivia.

2018: Quantitative Methods for Economic Analysis, Private University of Bolivia, La Paz, Bolivia.

2016: Bachelor of Economics, Autonomous University Juan Misael Saracho, Tarija, Bolivia.

Professional Experience

July 2025 – July 2028: Predoctoral Researcher in Training, University of Girona, Spain.

PhD researcher in Economics, conducting research on fiscal decentralization, intergovernmental spillovers, and subnational public finance.

August 2024 – July 2025: Research Consultant, Association of Councilwomen and Mayors of Bolivia (ACOBOL), La Paz, Bolivia.

Coordinator responsible for the Altiplano region for the implementation of the "Municipal Networks" Model, in collaboration with UN Women.

Conducted economic and financial studies in public management, primarily focused on local governments.

Feb 2024 – Jul 2024: Research Assistant, Institut d'Economia de Barcelona (IEB) and University of Barcelona, Spain.

Preparation of a database and data analysis for senior researchers.

Jun 2024 – Jul 2024: Public Budget Consultancy, Jubilee Foundation, La Paz, Bolivia.

Preparation of analysis document on the use of the public budget in Bolivia.

May 2023 – Aug 2023: Researcher, SWISSCONTACT, La Paz, Bolivia.

Elaboration of a research document. Preparation of a database of public expenditure of local governments in care; processing and analysis of information.

Jan 2021 – Sep 2022: Researcher, Bolivian Association of Councilwomen and Mayors (ACOBOL), La Paz, Bolivia.

Responsible for the implementation of a research project with UN Women, developing management models to optimize the protection system against violence toward women, girls, boys, and adolescents. Facilitated workshops for public authorities.

Jun 2021 – Aug 2021: Researcher, SWISSCONTACT, La Paz, Bolivia.

Preparation of the guide for identification and implementation of municipal own-source revenues.

Mar 2020 – Dec 2020: Professional in Analysis of Resources and Competency Expenditures, State Service of Autonomies – Ministry of the Presidency, La Paz, Bolivia.

Processing and analysis of budgetary information of autonomous governments.

Jun 2017 – Mar 2020: Budget Analyst, Ministry of Economy and Public Finance, La Paz, Bolivia.

Technical support in the development of the Fiscal Pact process. Processing and analysis of budgetary information of autonomous governments.

Oct 2016 – Jun 2017: Consultant in Budget and Taxation, Jubilee Foundation, La Paz, Bolivia.

Revision and elaboration of research documents.

Awards, Honors and Scholarships

April 2026: Scholarship Awardee, Barcelona School of Economics, Spain.

Awarded a scholarship for the summer school *Seeing Through the Algorithms: A Summer School on Machine Learning & AI for Economists* (6–10 July 2026).

June 2025: Honorable Mention for Best Master's Thesis in Public Finance, Department of Economy and Finance – **Government of Catalonia, Spain**.

Awarded for the master's thesis: *"Analyzing Fiscal Decentralization: Findings from a Quasi-Experimental Study in Municipalities"*.

Award ceremony attended by Alícia Romero Llano, Minister of Economy and Finance, and Antoni Fernández, Secretary of Finance of the Government of Catalonia.

2024: FI-SDUR Predoctoral Fellowship Awardee, Generalitat de Catalunya (AGAUR), Spain.

Competitive grant awarded for predoctoral researcher training and hiring (FI-SDUR 2024 program).

Teaching

First Semester 2026: Lecturer in International Economics, University of Girona, Spain.

Teaching two groups in the following programs: Bachelor's Degree in Economics, Double Degree in Business Administration and Management, and Double Degree in Industrial Engineering Technologies.

Topics: international trade, classical and modern models of specialization, and foundations of international economics.

October – November 2024: Instructor, Plurinational School of Public Management of Bolivia.

Delivery of the specialized course *Gender-Responsive Budgeting and Fiscal Justice, Version 5* (online).

Development of technical and methodological content focused on implementing gender-responsive budgeting in the Bolivian fiscal context.

Conference and Academic Participation

November 2026: Attendee, International Conference *Equalization in Decentralized Government Organized by the International Center for Decentralization and Governance (IDEAGOV).*

July 2026: Attendee, *Quality and University Integrity in the Era of Artificial Intelligence* AQU Catalunya & Consell Interuniversitari de Catalunya, University of Girona, Spain.

June 2026: Attendee, *XIV Workshop on Public Policy Design: Labor Markets, Institutions, and Inequality*, University of Girona, Girona, Spain.

May 2026: Presenter, *Advances in Spatial and Network Modelling for Policymaking – 2nd Edition*, Seville, Spain (28–29 May 2026).

Presentation of the second chapter of my doctoral thesis.

2026: Attendee, *UPF Memorial Day to Honor Ghazala Azmat*, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona, Spain.

January 2026: Presenter, 1st Seminar on Economics, Institutions and History: Violence, Social Conflicts and the Economy – Department of Economics, University of Girona, Spain.

Presentation of the paper: *"Causal Fiscal Spillovers under Decentralization: Evidence from Exogenous Revenue Shocks"*.

November 2025: Attendee, International Conference *Asymmetric Federalism: The Perils and Advantages of Asymmetric Decentralization Arrangements* – Santiago de Compostela, Spain (5–6 November 2025).

Organized by the *International Center for Decentralization and Governance (IDEAGOV)*, held at the Economic and Social Council of Galicia (CES).

June 2025: Presenter, 18th Meeting of Economists of Bolivia, Central Bank of Bolivia, Santa Cruz de la Sierra, Bolivia.

Presentation of the paper: *"Analyzing Fiscal Decentralization: Findings from a Quasi-Experimental Study in Municipalities"*.

Research Activities

July 2026: Summer School Participant, *Seeing Through the Algorithms: A Summer School on Machine Learning & AI for Economists*, Barcelona School of Economics, Spain.

March 2026: Executive Education Course Participant, Barcelona School of Economics, Spain.

Completed the course *Modern Approaches to Difference-in-Differences*.

Other Activities

2026 – 2027: Elected Member, Steering Committee of the Doctoral School (Student Sector – Social Sciences Area), University of Girona, Spain.

2026 – present: Member, *Public Policy Network for Bolivia – Tu Beca Bolivia* Program.

Policy brief in progress: *Municipal GDP per Capita for Bolivia.*

2026 – present: Tutor, *Tu Beca Bolivia* – Mentorship Program.

Providing personalized guidance to young Bolivians seeking international post-graduate scholarships; supporting profile development and application documents

2026: Committee Member, *X Jornades d'Investigadors Predoctorals de la UdG*, Escola de Doctorat, University of Girona, Spain.

Press Publications

September 2026. *Sharing Is Not Equalizing: Fiscal Equalization for the "50/50" Agenda.* Newspaper *La Razón*, Bolivia.

December 2025. *Asymmetric Decentralization.* Newspaper *La Razón*, Bolivia.

Analytical article on the Bolivian decentralization model and the need to move toward asymmetric arrangements based on empirical evidence.

October 2025. *Quiroga vs Paz: The Formula to Reform Bolivia's Decentralization.* Newspaper *La Razón*, Bolivia.

Comparative analysis of decentralization reform proposals and their consistency with economic theory and international evidence.

Research Documents

2025: Two documents: 1) *Towards Fairer Municipalities* and 2) *Finances that Protect.* UN Women and Association of Councilwomen and Mayors of Bolivia.

2024: *The Destination of Public Budget.* Jubilee Foundation.

2024: *Analyzing Fiscal Decentralization: Findings from a Quasi-Experimental Study in Municipalities.* University of Barcelona.

2023: *Guide on Shared Responsibility of Care for the Sustainability of Life.* Swisscontact.

2022: *Guide for the Supervision of Municipal Investment.* UN Women and Association of Councilwomen and Mayors of Bolivia.

2021: *Development of Management Models for the Effective Functioning of the Protection System Against Violence Toward Women, Children, and Adolescents.* UN Women and Association of Councilwomen and Mayors of Bolivia.

2021: *Methodological Guide for the Identification and Application of Municipal Own-Source Revenues.* SWISSCONTACT.

2020: *Finance and Expenditure Constraints of Autonomous Territorial Entities.* State Autonomy Service of Bolivia.

2019: *Direct Tax on Hydrocarbons.* Ministry of Economy and Public Finance of Bolivia.

2018: *Municipal Tax Revenues.* Ministry of Economy and Public Finance of Bolivia.

2017: *Revision of "12 Years of Direct Tax on Hydrocarbons".* Jubilee Foundation.

2017: *Fiscal Pact in Bolivia.* Jubilee Foundation.

2017: *Support in the preparation of "What Will the Governments Spend According to the 2017 and 2018 Budget".* Jubilee Foundation.